



Vaishakh Surendran

HOTEL OWNER ADVISOR

CONTACT

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CORE EXPERTISE

- Hotel Owner Advisory
- Commercial Performance Review
- Revenue & Yield Management
- Operational Governance
- Owner Reporting & Oversight
- Pre-Opening & Brand Audits
- Team Leadership (300+ staff)
- Sustainability & IGBC

Vaishakh Surendran

FOUNDER, VERITAS HOSPITALITY ADVISORS · HOTEL OWNER ADVISOR

Hotelier with 25+ years of operational leadership across India, the Maldives, Kuwait and the United States — including General Manager roles since 2015 under Accor, Wyndham, ITC and independent flags. Founder of Veritas Hospitality Advisors: India's dedicated hotel owner advisory practice, working exclusively on the owner's side of the table.

ADVISORY PRACTICE

Founder & Principal Advisor

2025 – Present

Veritas Hospitality Advisors · Pan-India

- › Independent hotel owner advisory — working exclusively for hotel owners, never for operators or brands
- › Commercial performance reviews: revenue positioning, OTA mix, yield management gaps, department-level P&L
- › Operational governance: owner reporting cadence, KPI frameworks, staff accountability structures
- › Current active engagement: Sanskreti The Heritage, Kochi (eco-island heritage resort, Vembanad backwaters)
- › Advisory structured around one engagement per destination — full attention, no conflicts

RECOGNITION

- **Best GM in Odisha 2024–25**
Odisha Tourism & Hospitality Awards
- **Odisha Best Employer 2025**
Employer recognition
- **CMO Asia Most Influential GMs 2025**
Industry ranking
- **IGBC Green Crusader 2025**
World Earth Day designation
- **Taj Award for Empowerment**
Taj Hotels, 2006–07
- **Fortune Hotels Highest Sales**
ITC Hotels group, Q2 2019
- **TripAdvisor Certificate of Excellence**
Keys Hotels Chennai, 2015

EDUCATION

Diploma in Hospitality Management
Institut Hôtelier César Ritz
Switzerland · 2001

Pre-Opening Internship
Hilton Geneva
Switzerland · 2000–01

INDUSTRY ROLES

- **HRACC Member (Govt of India)**
Representing FHRAI — Hotel Classification Committee
- **Founding Member, SKAL International**
Trivandrum chapter

HOTEL OPERATIONS — GENERAL MANAGER & SENIOR LEADERSHIP

General Manager

2022 – 2025

Lyfe Hotels & Resorts, Bhubaneswar · (Wyndham franchise)

- › Led property to 85% occupancy and ₹32 crore annual revenue with a 300-strong team
- › Recognised as Best General Manager in Odisha 2024–25 and Odisha Best Employer 2025
- › Named among CMO Asia's Most Influential General Managers 2025
- › Awarded IGBC Green Crusader designation, World Earth Day 2025
- › Managed US government diplomatic delegations and VIP protocol events

85% OCC

₹32 CR REV

BEST GM ODISHA

300+ TEAM

General Manager

2019 – 2022

Mercure Chennai Sriperumbudur · Accor

- › Grew revenue from ₹18 crore to ₹24 crore — a 33% uplift over the tenure
- › Achieved 100% brand audit score — highest in the Mercure brand across properties
- › #1 employee engagement score among all Mercure brand properties
- › 90% occupancy across peak periods; set new commercial benchmarks for the property

100% BRAND AUDIT

₹24 CR REV

#1 ENGAGEMENT

90% OCC

Owner's Representative (Remote)

2021 – 2022

Continental Hospitality · Two properties, Texas, USA

- › Owner-side representation for two hotels in Texas — remote oversight from India
- › Revenue management, commercial performance review and operational reporting for the ownership group

General Manager

2018 – 2019

Fortune Hotels (ITC Hotels Group)

- › Highest sales across the Fortune Hotels brand, Q2 2019 — awarded by ITC Hotels
- › Pre-opening and operational management responsibilities

General Manager

2015 – 2018

Keys Hotels, Chennai · Berggruen Hotels

- › TripAdvisor Certificate of Excellence, 2015 — property ranked among top-reviewed in segment
- › Full P&L ownership; built commercial and operational frameworks from the ground up

Senior Sales & F&B Leadership

2004 – 2015

Taj Hotels (Goa, Kovalam, Kochi) · Alila Hotels · CGH Earth · Radisson Blu Kuwait

- › Taj Fort Aguada, Goa: broke Conference & Banquets revenue records (corroborated by peers)
- › Taj Award for Empowerment — Taj Hotels, 2006–07
- › Radisson Blu Kuwait (2007–09): senior F&B & events leadership; managed VIP government delegations
- › Alila Hotels (Maldives): international resort operations in a luxury eco-flag environment
- › CGH Earth: Kerala heritage and eco-resort segment, owner-managed properties

Management Trainee → F&B Supervisor

2001 – 2004

Leela Hotels & Palaces · Kovalam, Kerala

- › Management trainee foundation at one of India's leading luxury hotel brands
- › Progressed to F&B Supervisor within the Leela Kovalam property

VERITAS ADVISORY APPROACH

- › Owner-side only — no operator engagements, no brand affiliations, no referral relationships
- › One active engagement per destination — guaranteed full attention
- › Deliverables: owner reporting cadence, commercial performance review, KPI benchmarks, governance structure
- › Founded on 25 years of seeing the owner's gap from inside hotel operations